

Negotiating Your Salary and Benefits Package

Much has been written about negotiating salary and benefits, but most of it boils down to knowing what you're worth in the marketplace, identifying which benefits are important to you, and putting a price tag on the benefits offered by your prospective employer so you can evaluate the real value of an offer. When meeting with prospective employers, find out what benefits and perks the company gives employees in the position you're applying for, what an average pay increase is, and what benefits the company might add to sweeten the pot if they're not able or willing to offer the salary you'd like.

Experts caution job seekers to delay discussing salary until well into the interview process and to avoid telling interviewers your current salary. You shouldn't be pegged at a salary range that's lower than the going rate just because you're underpaid in your current job, and discussing salary too early in the process can stick you with a lower than acceptable offer or, conversely, take you out of the running if your current salary is too high.



To find out how much you'd need to earn in a new city to equate to your current salary, use the cost of living calculator at www.homefair.com. Enter the city and state you're moving from and to, your current salary, and whether you'd prefer to own or rent.
